

Pharmacy Dispensing Guidelines

Pharmacy Department

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Department: Pharmacy Department

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1. Purpose & Scope

Defines the standard process for verifying, filling, and dispensing medication orders for inpatients, outpatients, and the emergency department at Shifa Hospital.

2. Prescription Verification

- Confirm patient identity using MR number and name/date of birth (two identifiers)
- Verify the prescriber's identity, signature, and license/stamp on the prescription
- Cross-check dosage, frequency, route, and duration against standard dosing references
- Check the patient's known allergies and current medication list for interactions

3. Dispensing Process

- Step 1: Receive prescription (physical or via HMS e-prescription)
- Step 2: Perform clinical and safety verification
- Step 3: Pick and label medication with patient name, MR number, dosage, and instructions
- Step 4: Independent second check for high-alert medications (see Medication Safety Policy PH-GL-02)
- Step 5: Counsel the patient/attendant on dosage, timing, and possible side effects
- Step 6: Record dispensing in the HMS and update inventory

4. Controlled Substances

Controlled and narcotic medications are stored in a locked cabinet with dual-key access and logged in a dedicated controlled-substance register at the time of every dispensing, co-signed by the pharmacist and the requesting nurse or physician.

5. Inventory Management

Stock levels are reviewed daily; expiry dates are checked weekly using a first-expiry-first-out (FEFO) rotation. Any medication within 3 months of expiry is flagged for priority use or return.

6. Returned Medication

Unused inpatient medication returned to the pharmacy is only restocked if the packaging is intact and storage conditions can be confirmed; otherwise it is disposed of per hospital waste policy.